

Austin Sonny Stethem

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Executive Summary

High-agency **FP&A and Data Analyst** combining strategic finance with hands-on technical execution. A relentless problem-solver who thrives in ambiguity, I **leverage AI-assisted development** to rapidly architect **front-to-back analytics stacks**—from backend **Python/SQL** data engines to interactive JavaScript **dashboards**. By building these custom applications, I bypass legacy IT roadblocks and directly drive enterprise revenue. **Operating as a cross-functional bridge**, I manage the structural integrity of a **multi-million SKU database** across an **80-branch network**, engineering **machine learning simulations** and **geospatial pricing models** to reconcile replacement costs with realized **P&L** and protect enterprise profitability.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Financial Strategy: Tiered Margins, KVI Cross-Subsidization, Activity-Based Costing (ABC), TCO, Price Waterfalls

Master Data Governance: AutoCare (ACES/PIES), SKU Lifecycles, Supersession Chaining, Hazmat Compliance

Full-Stack Analytics: SQL, Python (Geopandas, Pandas, Scikit-Learn, Flask, Jupyter), JS (Leaflet, Chart.js), Phocas BI

Leadership & Ops: AI-Accelerated Development, End-to-End Execution, POS Troubleshooting, Crisis Management

WORK EXPERIENCE

Merrill Company, Arnold Motor Supply

Spencer, Iowa

Inventory, Product, and Pricing Analyst

September 2021 – Present

Strategic Finance & Master Data Governance

- **ERP Governance:** One of three personnel with root-level access to audit, modify, and deploy enterprise pricing across 80 branches; cleanse/map vendor files to internal SQL schemas for zero-defect updates.
- **AutoCare Standards:** Manage PCdb/VCdb integrations for 565+ manufacturer lines; align ERP nomenclature with national standards to ensure fitment accuracy and eliminate catalog fragmentation.
- **Full-Stack BI Development:** Leveraged AI-assisted coding to build front-to-back analytics applications—from Python/Flask data engines to interactive JavaScript dashboards—transitioning the department from manual audits to live margin-defense tracking.
- **SKU Onboarding:** Execute Just-In-Time master data creation for active POS demand; use Excel logic to cascade pricing matrices and validate Hazmat/regulatory compliance.
- **B2B Support:** Execute B2B onboarding with <3-min SLAs by cloning complex pricing matrices; resolve root-cause POS errors mid-transaction to prevent dropped sales.

Margin Defense & Strategic Intelligence

- **Margin Modeling:** Developed a Python Monte Carlo simulation to forecast supply chain margin risk; modeled landed-cost volatility by integrating utility overhead, freight, and ABC velocity (approved by Lead Managing Partner).
- **Governance:** Enforce margin floors by auditing POS overrides and rejecting non-compliant discounts; restructure field-level pricing requests to maintain baseline profitability.
- **Variance Analysis:** Model P&L impact of supplier cost fluctuations to define cost-pass-through percentages prior to ERP deployment.
- **Gap Diagnostics:** Use Phocas BI to isolate localized market friction; conduct stratified sampling across KVIs and low-velocity SKUs to deploy targeted price optimizations.
- **Attrition Analytics:** Built Excel Power Query dashboards to track account attrition, separating operational fulfillment failures from pricing discrepancies.
- **B2B Quoting:** Model competitive pricing for state, municipal, and commercial fleet bids, utilizing historical cost data to secure high-volume RFPs.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Iowa Lakes CC** — Associate of Arts & Associate of Science
- **W3Schools** — Certified in Data Science & Certified SQL Developer

Emmetsburg, IA
Online